Semester AI feature audit: every reading, tutoring, note-scanning, and quiz-generation capability broken down by module

Computer
Build an interactive study dashboard comparing Semester AI's document reader, AI tutor, and note organizer with feature-by-feature workflows
Computer
How does the AI reading companion work in practice
What note scanning features does Semester AI include
Compare Semester AI with other student study apps

I built an interactive study-dashboard prototype with module filters, feature search, evidence-status filters, and an app-comparison table. The audit below separates Semester AI's advertised reading, tutoring, and note-scanning features from quiz-generation capabilities that remain unverified.[1]

One important correction: your separate Semester platform project should not be conflated with Bawano Technologies' "Semester AI – Reader, Tutors" Android app. My previous answers described the Bawano app; this audit continues that public-app scope, not an audit of your implementation.[1]

Interactive dashboard

The attached HTML dashboard includes:

- Reader, Tutor, Notes, and Quiz module filters.
- Search across features, workflows, and documentation gaps.
- "Advertised" and "Unverified" evidence filters.
- Feature-by-feature illustrative workflows.
- A comparison with Google's NotebookLM/Gemini Notebook and RemNote.
- Links to the underlying product sources.

Open the HTML document in a browser to use its controls. It is an interactive audit prototype—not a live AI reader, scanner, tutor, or quiz generator.

The dashboard distinguishes developer-advertised capabilities from independently tested functionality. Semester AI's retrieved store description was last updated April 18, 2025, and does not document quiz generation.[1]

Module-by-module audit

This covers the capabilities named in the public description. It cannot establish every function available inside the installed app.

Document reader

Capability	Evidence status	Illustrative workflow	What is not established
Open and browse PDFs	Advertised	Open a PDF → browse its content → read the relevant section.	File-size limits, navigation tools, and performance.
Create PDFs	Advertised	Create a PDF → open it in the reader.	Creation methods and editing options.
Ask the reading companion questions	Advertised	Read a difficult passage → ask for an explanation → compare the response with the original.	Page citations, exact context handling, and accuracy.
Summarize PDF content	Advertised	Open a document → request a summary → check it against the document.	Summary length controls and section selection.
Convert Word documents to PDF	Advertised	Convert a Word document → open the resulting PDF → interact with the AI.	Supported Word formats and formatting fidelity.

All five capabilities appear in the developer's store description. No technical documentation there establishes the model, retrieval architecture, or document-processing pipeline. [1]

Tutoring

Capability	Evidence status	Illustrative workflow	What is not established
Course-specific AI tutors	Advertised	Find a course tutor → ask a concept question → review the explanation.	Covered subjects, model choice, and access to your documents.
Human tutors	Advertised	Find a relevant tutor → consult or ask questions.	Qualifications, prices, booking, and response times.
Tutor availability	Marketed as "24/7"	Access the tutor catalog when help is needed.	Whether human tutors are immediately available around the clock.

The listing supports a tutoring catalog, but does not establish adaptive lesson plans, mastery tracking, automated grading, or live video tutoring. [1]

Note organizer

Capability	Evidence status	Illustrative workflow	What is not established
Scan notes	Advertised	Capture notes → review the captured content.	Camera controls, automatic cropping, and batch scanning.
AI digitization and organization	Advertised	Capture notes → obtain organized digital content → check for errors.	Handwriting accuracy, OCR method, and organization rules.

Capability	Evidence status	Illustrative workflow	What is not established
Enhance and edit notes	Advertised	Open digitized notes → edit or enhance them → review the changes.	Specific AI editing commands.
Annotate notes	Advertised	Open notes → add annotations.	Highlighting, drawing, comments, or other exact tool types.
Back up documents	Advertised	Back up a document → retain access to it.	Storage quotas, version history, and recovery behavior.
Synchronize across devices	Advertised	Synchronize documents → access them from another device.	Supported platforms and offline conflict handling.
Share documents and classwork	Advertised	Choose a document → share it with other Semester AI users.	Sharing permissions, expiration, and revocation.

These are developer claims, not tested results. Cross-device synchronization does not by itself prove that native desktop or iOS apps exist. [1]

Quiz generation

Capability	Audit result
Generate quizzes from PDFs	Unverified
Generate flashcards from notes	Unverified
Select difficulty or question count	Unverified
Multiple-choice or free-response questions	Unverified
Score answers and explain mistakes	Unverified
Schedule spaced-repetition practice	Unverified

The earlier search preview mentioned learning games and quizzes, but the retrieved full store description does not substantiate them. Consequently, quiz generation should remain an open verification item—not a confirmed feature or a proven absence. [1]

Reading companion in practice

The documented user-facing behavior is straightforward: read a PDF, ask about confusing content, or request a summary. The listing does not explain what happens internally. [1]

Here is an illustrative software-engineering study session—not a tested walkthrough of the app:

1. Open a PDF about database transactions.
2. Ask: “Explain atomicity using the examples in this document.”
3. Follow up: “How is atomicity different from isolation?”
4. Request: “Summarize the main points in five bullets.”
5. Compare the explanation with the relevant passages in the PDF.

Those prompts illustrate the advertised explanation and summarization functions. They do not establish that the app can return accurate page citations, interpret diagrams, or restrict every answer to the uploaded document.[1]

The important distinction is between an advertised reading companion and a verified source-grounded assistant. Semester AI advertises the former; its public listing does not document the citation or grounding controls needed to establish the latter.[1]

Note scanning in practice

Semester AI specifically advertises capturing notes and having AI transform them into organized digital content, followed by editing, enhancement, and annotation.[1]

A useful acceptance-test workflow would be:

1. Capture a clearly written page of notes.
2. Inspect the resulting digital content for omissions.
3. Check headings, numbers, equations, and unusual terminology.
4. Edit an error and confirm the correction persists.
5. Add an annotation.
6. Verify backup, synchronization, and sharing separately.

That is a proposed test procedure—not a claim that each step has been independently verified.

Before relying on the scanner for coursework, these are the unresolved capabilities to test:

Scanning dimension	Public evidence
Capturing notes	Explicitly advertised.
Producing organized digital content	Explicitly advertised.
Editing and annotation afterward	Explicitly advertised.
Handwritten-text recognition accuracy	Not specified.
Equation and diagram recognition	Not specified.
Multi-page scanning	Not specified.
Automatic cropping and perspective correction	Not specified.
Searchable PDF export	Not specified.
Offline scanning or processing	Not specified.

The listing establishes the broad capture-to-digital-notes workflow, but not these implementation details.[1]

Comparison with other apps

Google's current student page identifies NotebookLM as "Gemini Notebook" following a July 2026 rename. The comparison uses both names to make the product recognizable.[2]

Dimension	Semester AI	Google NotebookLM / Gemini Notebook	RemNote
Document reading	PDF reader with questions and summaries advertised.[1]	Source-based study materials and explanations documented.[3] [2]	Reader with highlights, annotations, and linked notes documented.[4]
AI tutoring	Course-specific AI tutors advertised; document context unspecified.[1]	Learning Guide and explanations tied to source materials documented.[3]	Tutor can see the PDF and search other notes when helpful.[4]
Notes	Scanning, digitization, editing, backup, and synchronization advertised.[1]	Upload notes and other class materials; a dedicated scanner is not established by these sources.[2]	Integrated notes, document annotations, and learning from your own notes documented.[5] [4]
Flashcards	Unverified in the retrieved full description.[1]	Document-based flashcards with customization documented.[3]	Cards generated from notes, PDFs, and study materials documented.[6]
Quizzes	Unverified.[1]	Personalized source-based quizzes with explanations documented.[3] [2]	Multiple-choice and free-response quizzes with adjustable difficulty documented.[5]
Guided study workflow	No detailed sequence documented.[1]	Learning Guide plus source-grounded practice tools documented.[3]	Section-by-section summaries, flashcards, and quizzes documented.[5]
Human help and community	Human tutor catalog, course communities, chat, and study groups advertised.[1]	The cited study documentation does not establish a human-tutor marketplace.[3] [2]	The cited reader and guided-learning documentation does not establish a human-tutor marketplace.[5] [4]

For document-based explanations and cited practice questions, Google's product has clearer public evidence. For a connected reader → notes → flashcards → quiz workflow, RemNote has the most explicit documentation among these three. Semester AI's advertised distinction is combining scanning and reading with course communities and human tutors—but its quiz functionality and several implementation details still require verification.[3] [4] [5] [1]

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1. https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=tech.bawano.semester&hl=en_US
2. https://notebooklm.google/students
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